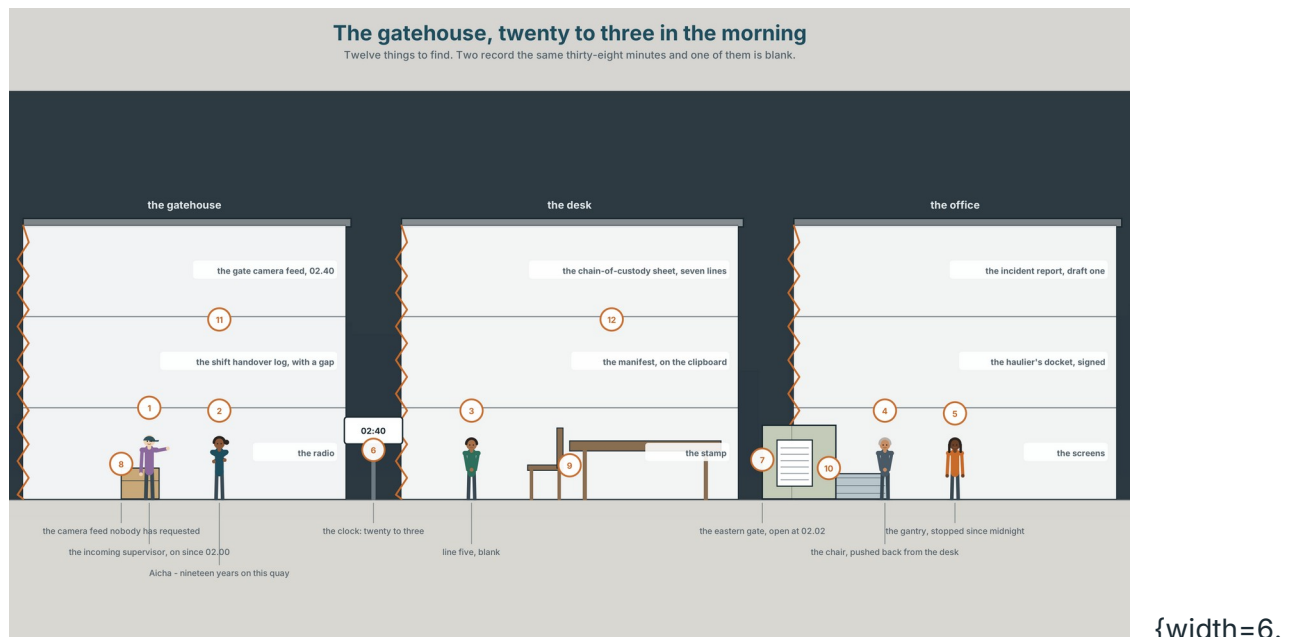


Table of Contents

B2.2 • Unit 2 • The Goods Were Released

English Animated • *Holding the Floor* • a port and its logistics chain, Rotterdam Student's
Book pages 28–49 • 22 pp • ~11 hours

Part 0 • The Big Picture ♦ A • THE WORLD



6in}

The gatehouse, twenty to three in the morning — Twelve things to find. Two record the same thirty-eight minutes and one of them is blank.

Who did this, and who wants you to know?

By the end of this unit you can choose the voice of a sentence on purpose, and say what each choice hides. Two hundred words.

♦ A • THE WORLD

♦ B • THE SYSTEM

A container released at two forty in the morning, and a report with twenty-six passives and no names in it

the passive as an information-structure choice • 28 words for operations and responsibility • 22 words and frames for suppressing an agent • de-stressing the agent

◆ A • THE WORLD

A container released at two forty in the morning, and a report with twenty-six passives and no names in it

◆ C • THE PERFORMANCE

Two hundred words in which every voice was chosen

0A • Find it

Find twelve things in this picture. Two of them record the same thirty-eight minutes and one of them is blank.

the gate camera feed, 02.40 · the shift handover log, with a gap in it · the manifest on the clipboard · the release stamp · the gantry, stopped · the chain-of-custody sheet, seven lines · the incident report, draft one · the haulier's docket, signed · a radio on the desk · a bank of screens showing the quay · a clock at 02.40 · a chair pushed back from the desk

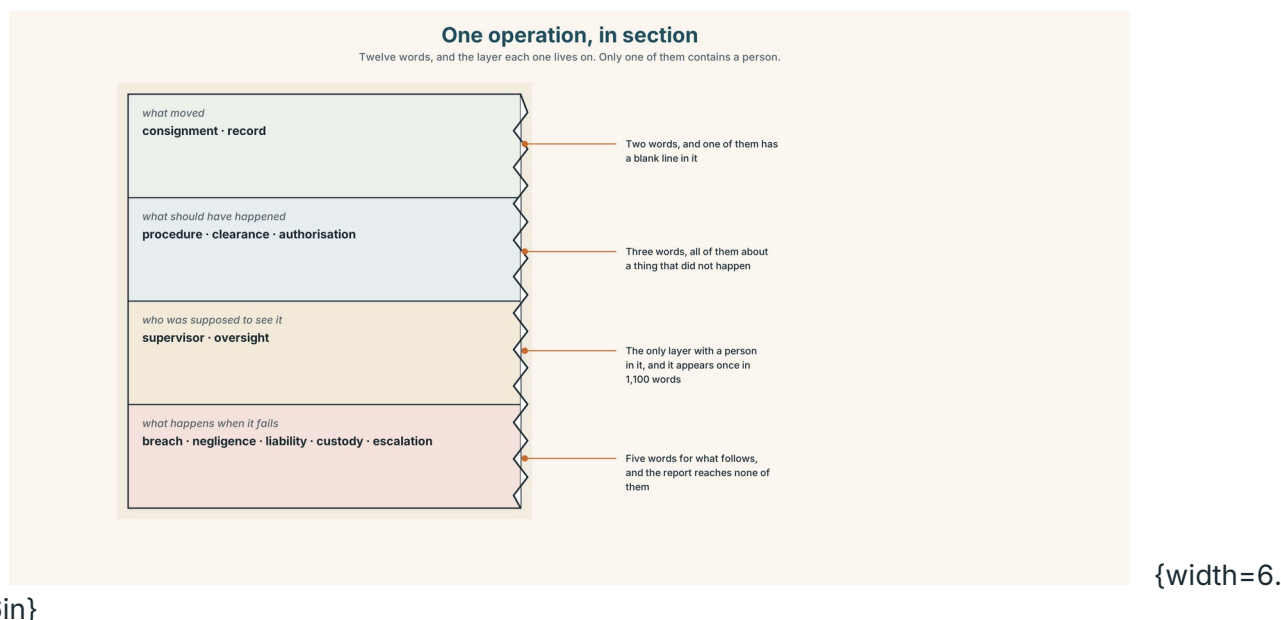
0B • Guess it

One document in this picture would answer the whole question, and it has nothing on it. Which, and what does an empty line in it actually mean?

0C • Say it 🗨️

Record sixty seconds. Describe something that went wrong where you work or study, twice: once naming everybody and once naming nobody. You will record it again at the end of this unit.

Part 1 • Vocabulary Lab 1 ◆ B • THE SYSTEM



6in}

One operation, in section — Twelve words, and the layer each one lives on. Only one of them contains a person.

1A • Meet — the words of an operation

Match each word to one layer of the cutaway.

consignment · procedure · authorisation · supervisor · record · negligence · clearance · custody · liability · oversight · escalation · breach

1B • Sort — what moved, who was supposed to see it, or what happens when it goes wrong?

Three columns. **One of the twelve names a person and eleven name things, which is the shape of the report in Part 5. Count how often that one appears in it.**

consignment · supervisor · clearance · breach · liability · procedure · negligence · oversight · authorisation · custody · record · escalation

1C • Meet — the five phrases an incident report lives on

chain of custody	Seven lines, each with a name and a time. One of them is blank.
standard operating procedure	What should have happened. Never what did.
the shift handover	Twelve minutes in which nobody is formally responsible for anything.
a near miss	Something that did not happen, reported as though it had.
root cause	The point at which the investigation decides to stop.

1D • Collocation Lab

Complete each one, and say which of the five is the only one that names a person.

at some point · the goods were released · a procedural failure · on whose authority · signed off by

1. _____ at 02.40, and the report says no more than that.
2. _____ between 02.02 and 02.40 the gate was opened.
3. The release was _____ a supervisor whose name is not in the document.
4. The question the board asked twice was _____ .
5. The finding is _____ , which is a conclusion about a document and not about anybody.

1E • The phrasal verbs, and the three fixed expressions

sign off · hand over · flag up

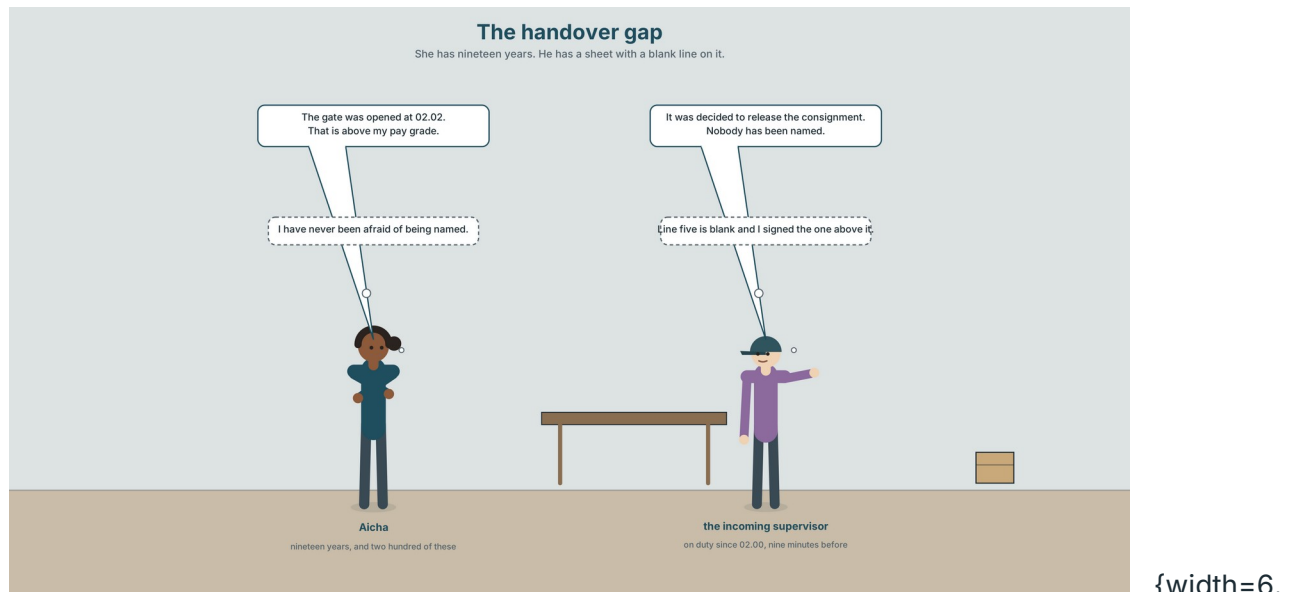
f it was authorised · f nobody has been named · f that is above my pay grade

One of these fixed expressions is a refusal and two are statements. Which is the refusal, and what is the speaker actually declining to do?

1F • Own it

Write one sentence about something that went wrong recently, in the passive, and underneath it write the name the passive is standing in front of.

Part 2 • Listening ♦ A • THE WORLD



6in}

The handover gap — She has nineteen years. He has a sheet with a blank line on it.

2A • The handover gap 🎧 Track 2.1

Before you listen. A container left the terminal at 02.40 without customs clearance. The chain-of-custody sheet has seven lines. Line five is blank. The shift supervisor has been on the quay for nineteen years.

Listen once. What is agreed, and what is the one fact nobody in the room has?

Listen again. Complete the table.

	What happened	Who did it	How the report says it
the gate			
line five			
the release			

Listen again. True or false?

- The container left at two forty. ☐ T ☐ F
- Line five of the sheet is blank. ☐ T ☐ F
- The supervisor authorised the release. ☐ T ☐ F
- The handover gap is thirty-eight minutes. ☐ T ☐ F

Noticing. Six sentences from the recording.

- Somebody opened the gate at 02.02.*
- The gate was opened at 02.02.*
- The gate was opened by the night supervisor at 02.02.*

4. At 02.02 the gate was opened.
5. It was decided to release the consignment.
6. The consignment was released, the gate having been opened at 02.02.

All six are about one event. Which of them contain an agent, which put the time first, and which one could not be written at all without the passive?

2B • Decoding clinic 🎧 Track 2.2

Thirty seconds at speed. Three jobs.

1. One speaker says *it was decided* twice. Mark the stress in both.
 2. Where does the voice fall in *the gate was opened by the night supervisor*?
 3. Somebody says *that is above my pay grade*. What had just been asked?
-

Part 3 • Grammar Lab 1 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

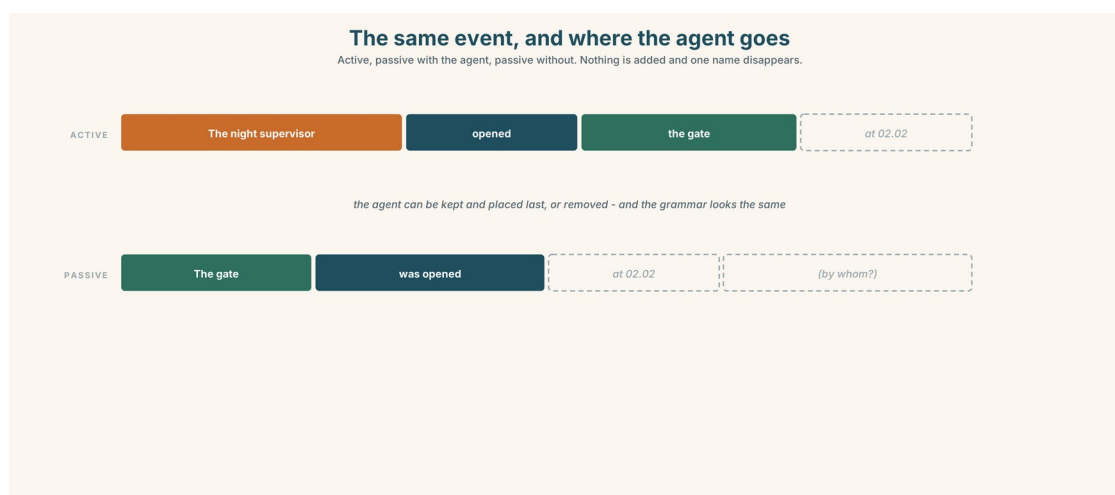
Choosing which end of the sentence the subject goes

3A • Notice

Look at the six sentences in Part 2 again.

1. Which sentences name the person, and which merely allow one?
2. Sentence 4 and sentence 2 contain the same words. **What is different, and what does it change?**
3. Sentence 5 has a subject that is not a thing. **What is it doing there?**
4. Sentence 6 is a participle clause. **What has happened to the gate-opening, and why?**

3B • See



6in}

{width=6.

The same event, and where the agent goes — Active, passive with the agent, passive without. Nothing is added and one name disappears.

3C • Know

the passive without an agent	<i>The gate was opened.</i>	the actor is removed and no rule is broken
the passive with an agent	<i>The gate was opened by the supervisor.</i>	the actor is named, and placed last
the passive to keep a topic	<i>The consignment was logged, inspected and released.</i>	one subject, three verbs, no repetition
the passive to put the new fact last	<i>At 02.02 the gate was opened.</i>	time first, event last, which is where English wants it
the impersonal <i>it</i>	<i>It was decided to release it.</i>	the deciding has no decider and no date
agent suppression by nominalisation	<i>The release of the consignment followed.</i>	even the verb has gone

The passive is not a way of being vague. It is a way of deciding what the sentence is about. *The gate was opened by the supervisor* is a sentence about the gate; *The supervisor opened the gate* is a sentence about the supervisor. Both name him, and they belong in different paragraphs.

An agentless passive is a choice, and the reader cannot tell which kind. Sometimes the agent is unknown, sometimes it is obvious, sometimes it is being protected, and the grammar looks identical in all three cases. That is the whole of this unit.

the institutional set	<i>it was decided · a decision was taken · action has been taken</i>
the review set	<i>the matter is being reviewed · steps are being taken · it is understood</i>
the closing set	<i>lessons have been learned · an error occurred · no individual has been identified</i>
what organisations do	<i>look into · follow up · put down to</i>

Why it matters. Every incident report in the world is written in this grammar, and it is the grammar of safety as well as of evasion. Telling the two apart is a professional skill, and it starts with being able to produce both.

3D • Use — controlled

Rewrite each one in the voice the purpose in brackets requires.

The night supervisor opened the gate at 02.02. (1) *(the paragraph is about the gate)*
Somebody released the consignment. (2) *(the agent is genuinely unknown)* We decided to release it. (3) *(an institutional decision with no date)* The gate was opened at 02.02. (4) *(put the time first, keep the passive)* The gate was opened and then the consignment was released. (5) *(one participle clause)*

3E • Use — guided

Put the agent back into each one, and say what the sentence is now about.

1. The gate was opened at 02.02.
2. It was decided to release the consignment.
3. Line five was left blank.
4. The matter is being reviewed.
5. The release of the consignment followed.

3F • Use — open

In pairs. One of you reads a passive sentence from a real document. The other asks *by whom?* until either a name appears or the first speaker can say why there is not one. **Four each.**

3G • Error autopsy

× *The gate was opened by at 02.02.* × *It was decided by the decision to release it.* ×
Having opened the gate, the consignment was released.

For each, name the rule and say what the writer was reaching for.

3H • Check — eight items

1. The night supervisor opened the gate. → *(make it about the gate, and keep him in it)*
 2. Somebody released the consignment. → *(agent genuinely unknown)*
 3. We decided to release it. → *(institutional, no date)*
 4. The gate was opened at 02.02. → *(time first)*
 5. The gate was opened and the consignment was released. → *(one participle clause)*
 6. × *Having opened the gate, the consignment was released.* → correct it.
 7. Rewrite *The matter is being reviewed* so that somebody is doing the reviewing.
 8. Rewrite *An error occurred* twice: once where the agent is unknown and once where it is not.
-

Part 4 • Speaking ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

4A • Fluency starter — by whom?

One person reads a passive sentence aloud. Everybody else asks *by whom?* **The sentence is not finished until either a name arrives or the reader can say why none exists.**

4B • The functional core — choosing voice deliberately

The same thirty-eight minutes, two reports

Both accurate. One of them can be acted on by a named person.

as filed

1,100 words · 26 passives · 2 names, both external · 0 owners

with an actions table

1,100 words · 26 passives · 8 table lines · 6 owners, 2 systems

1

1

Find the six. One report contains a line somebody could be asked about. Which, and how many such lines are there?

6 differences — find them all

The same thirty-eight minutes, two reports — Both accurate. One of them can be acted on by a named person.

Language Bank

keeping the topic	<i>the consignment was logged, inspected and released</i>
removing the agent	<i>it was decided · a decision was taken · an error occurred</i>
promising movement	<i>steps are being taken · the matter is being reviewed · action has been taken</i>
naming without blaming	<i>the gate was opened by the night supervisor, who had not been briefed</i>

Information gap. Learner A has the camera log. Learner B has the chain-of-custody sheet.
Reconstruct the thirty-eight minutes by speaking only, and write one sentence about each.

4C • The performance — three minutes

Present an incident in three minutes. **Every sentence must have its voice chosen, and you must be able to say why for any three your partner picks.**

Record it.

4D • Observer

One person marks every passive and writes beside it whether the agent is unknown, obvious or protected.

4E • Three criteria

- ☐ Could I justify the voice of every sentence? ☐ Did any agentless passive hide something I actually knew? ☐ Did the topic of each paragraph stay in subject position?

Part 5 • Reading ♦ A • THE WORLD

5A • Predict

The title is **"Line five."** What does a blank line on a signed form prove, and what does it only suggest?

5B • Read — two minutes

Line five

At 02.40 on 14 March a forty-foot consignment left the terminal by the eastern gate. It had not been cleared. The haulier's docket was signed. The chain-of-custody sheet has seven lines; line five, which records the authorising supervisor, is blank.

The incident report runs to eleven hundred words. A standards officer counted the passive constructions in it: twenty-six. It contains two names, both of them employees of other companies.

The report says the gate was opened at 02.02, that the consignment was released, that a procedural failure occurred during the shift handover, and that the matter is being reviewed. All four sentences are true. Not one of them has a person in it.

The handover runs from 02.00 to 02.12. For those twelve minutes the outgoing supervisor has handed over and the incoming one has not yet taken responsibility. The gap between the gate opening and the departure is thirty-eight minutes, and the camera feed covers all of it.

Nobody has watched the camera feed. It was not requested, because the report was already written, and the report was written from the chain-of-custody sheet, on which line five is blank.

5C • Comprehension — eight questions

1. When did the consignment leave, and by which gate?
2. How many lines does the chain-of-custody sheet have, and which one is blank?
3. How long is the report, and how many passives does it contain?
4. How many names are in it, and who are they?
5. How long is the handover, and how long is the gap?
6. **Why does the writer point out that both named people work for other companies?**
7. **"All four sentences are true." What is the writer establishing before making the next point?**
8. **The last paragraph is a loop. Describe the loop, and say which step a reader would break first.**

5D • Vocabulary in context

Infer from the text, then check.

had not been cleared • records the authorising supervisor • has handed over • the camera feed covers all of it • it was not requested

5E • The counter-text

The report, every agent accounted for

Eleven hundred words, twenty-six passives, and two names from other companies.

INCIDENT REPORT - EASTERN GATE - 14 MARCH

"The gate was opened at 02.02. The consignment was released. A procedural failure occurred during the shift handover. The matter is being reviewed."

"It was decided that documentation would be completed retrospectively. No individual has been identified."

WHAT THE SENTENCE SAYS	AGENT	WHICH KIND
THE GATE WAS OPENED	NOT NAMED	ON CAMERA - KNOWABLE
THE CONSIGNMENT WAS RELEASED	NOT NAMED	OBVIOUS
A PROCEDURAL FAILURE OCCURRED	NONE POSSIBLE	A SYSTEM
THE MATTER IS BEING REVIEWED	NOT NAMED	PROTECTED
IT WAS DECIDED	NOT NAMED	PROTECTED
PASSIVES IN 1,100 WORDS	26	--
NAMES IN THE REPORT	2	BOTH EXTERNAL
CAMERA FEED REQUESTED	NO	--

THE SEVEN LINES OF THE CHAIN OF CUSTODY

lines 1 to 4 logged, inspected, sealed, staged - all signed

line 5: authorising supervisor blank

line 6: gate release signed, 02.31

line 7: haulier receipt signed, 02.40

The report was written from the sheet. The sheet has a blank line. Nothing in the report is false, and nothing in it is answerable.

Four sentences, four passives, nought people

A decision with no decider and a finding with nobody in it

Three of the five agents were knowable at the time

Lines 6 and 7 are signed either side of the blank one

Written from the sheet, so the gap became the account

6in}

The report, every agent accounted for — Eleven hundred words, twenty-six passives, and two names from other companies.

Read the incident report and answer.

1. How many passive constructions are in the first paragraph?
2. **Find every sentence in which an agent could have been named and was not, and say in each case whether it is unknown, obvious or protected.**
3. The report names two people. **Why those two?**
4. **Rewrite the four main findings so that each has an owner and a date.**

5F • Two texts

The report says *a procedural failure occurred during the shift handover*. The sheet says *line five: blank*.

Which of these is a finding? Write two sentences, and use the word *oversight* in one of them.

Part 6 • Vocabulary Lab 2 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Saying that something happened without saying who

6A • Sort — how it happened, when it was done, or by whom?

Three columns.

inadvertently · belatedly · independently · routinely · provisionally · systematically · formally · unaccountably

6B • Chunk completion

1. _____ to release the consignment. *(three words)*
2. _____ at a meeting nobody has minuted. *(four words)*
3. _____ since the incident. *(four words — movement promised)*
4. _____ by the compliance team. *(four words — more movement)*
5. _____, and the report says no more. *(four words — faults, no owner)*
6. _____ that the gate was already open. *(three words — attributed to nobody)*
7. _____. *(four words — the review that has no end date)*
8. _____. *(five words — the sentence that closes the file)*

6C • Three that are not interchangeable

it was decided · a decision was taken · action has been taken

Say which one hides a person, which one hides a meeting, and which one hides whether anything has changed.

6D • The phrasal verbs and the fixed expressions

look into · follow up · put down to

f *lessons have been learned · f* *an error occurred · f* *we are unable to comment*

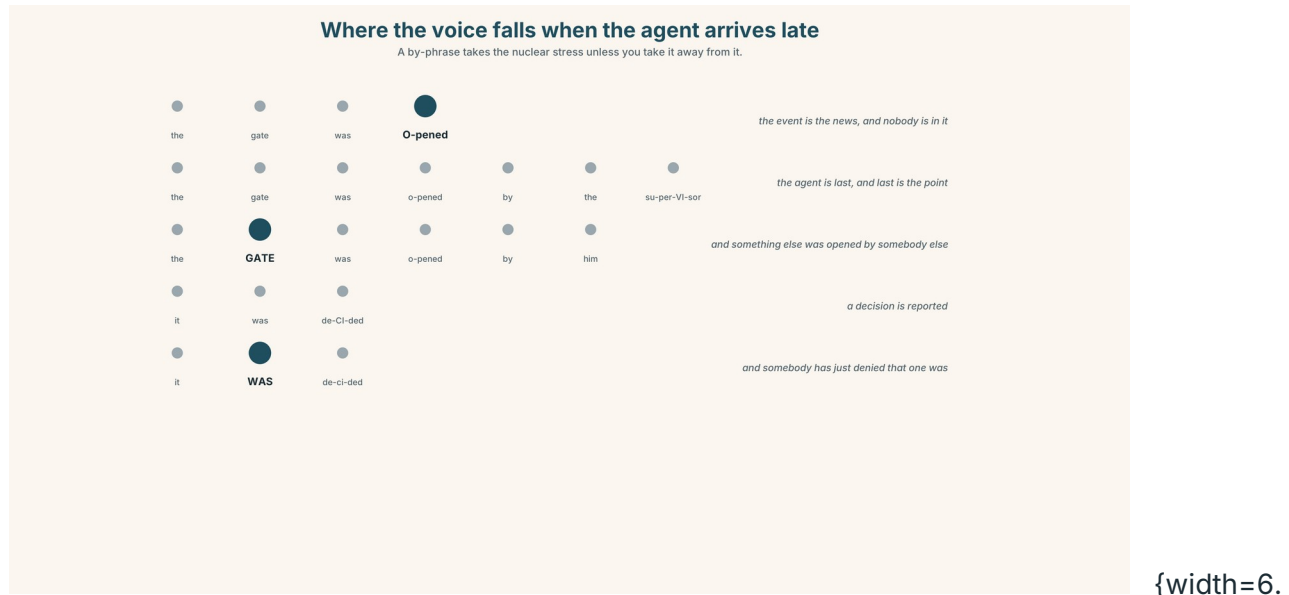
One of these fixed expressions has a subject that cannot be identified even in principle. Which, and who exactly would have learned them?

6E • Contrast Clinic

Eight items. Rewrite each sentence as the bracket asks.

1. The night supervisor opened the gate. *(make it about the gate, keep him in it)*
 2. Somebody released the consignment. *(agent genuinely unknown)*
 3. We decided to release it. *(institutional, undated)*
 4. The gate was opened at 02.02. *(time first)*
 5. An error occurred. *(name the error and its owner)*
 6. The matter is being reviewed. *(say who is reviewing it and by when)*
 7. Lessons have been learned. *(say who learned what, and what changed)*
 8. Line five was left blank. *(name the person and the moment)*
-

Part 7 • Pronunciation & Fluency Lab ♦ B • THE SYSTEM



6in}

Where the voice falls when the agent arrives late — A by-phrase takes the nuclear stress unless you take it away from it.

Where the voice falls when an agent arrives late

7A • Hear 🎧 Track 2.3

The gate was OPENED. — the event is the news, and there is nobody in it *The gate was opened by the SUPERVISOR.* — the agent is last, and the last word is the point *The gate was opened by the supervisor, who had not been BRIEFED.* — the agent is swallowed

7B • Say

Say all three. Then say this:

It was DECIDED. — and then: *It WAS decided.* The first reports a decision. The second says somebody has just denied that one was made.

7C • Make it mean something

Say these two:

The gate was opened by the night supervisor. — the stress on *supervisor*: that is the news
The gate was opened by the night supervisor. — the stress on *gate*: and something else was opened by somebody else

A by-phrase at the end of a passive takes the nuclear stress unless you take it away, and taking it away is how a writer names somebody without pointing at them.

7D • Fluency 30 🟡

Thirty seconds: **one event, four sentences, the agent arriving in a different place each time.** Three times, faster.

Part 8 • Writing ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

An incident account with every voice chosen • 200 words

8A • Read the model

At 02.02 the eastern gate was opened. [time first, event last: the passive is doing information structure, not hiding anybody]

The consignment was logged at 01.48, loaded at 02.19 and released at 02.40 without customs clearance. [one subject, four verbs, no repetition – the passive is the only way to write this sentence once]

Line five of the chain-of-custody sheet, which records the authorising supervisor, was left blank by the incoming night supervisor, who had taken responsibility nine minutes earlier. [the agent is named and placed last, and the relative clause after it carries the mitigation]

The camera feed covering the thirty-eight minutes has not been requested. It will be reviewed by the standards officer by 28 March. [one agentless passive, deliberately: nobody requested it, and that is the finding – followed immediately by a passive with an owner and a date]

Questions about the writer's choices:

1. The first sentence has no agent. **Is anybody being protected? How do you know?**
2. The third sentence names somebody and then immediately adds a clause. **What is that clause doing, and is it fair?**
3. The last paragraph has two passives doing opposite jobs. **Name both.**

8B • The anti-model

A procedural failure occurred during the shift handover. It was decided that the consignment should be released. An error was made in the completion of documentation. The matter is being reviewed and steps are being taken to ensure that lessons are learned going forward.

Four sentences, six agentless passives, and not one person, date or document in any of them. **Rewrite it with an owner and a date on every finding.**

8C • Plan

time first, event last → one subject carrying four verbs → the agent named and placed last, with its mitigation → one deliberate agentless passive, then one with an owner and a date

8D • Write — 200 words

8E • Peer review — three criteria

☐ Can you justify the voice of every sentence? ☐ Does any agentless passive conceal something you know? ☐ Does each finding have somebody who could be asked about it?

8F • Write it again • 8G • Publish

Rewrite after review. **Publish both, and mark each passive as unknown, obvious or protected.**

Part 9 • The File ♦ A • THE WORLD + C • THE PERFORMANCE

Four paragraphs that change subject every sentence

A learner taught to avoid the passive writes a paragraph about four different things.

STUDY FILE - THE PASSIVE YOU WERE TAUGHT TO AVOID

You were told the passive is weak writing, and then you met it on every page of everything you read professionally. Both of those are true.

THE PARAGRAPH IS ABOUT	SUBJECTS USED	WHAT WOULD HOLD IT
THE SAMPLE	WE, I, THE LAB, IT	THE SAMPLE WAS ...
THE APPLICATION	YOU, THEY, THE OFFICE	THE APPLICATION IS ...
THE MACHINE	SOMEBODY, WE, IT	THE MACHINE IS ...
THE RULE	PEOPLE, THEY, ONE	THE RULE IS ...
THE STORY	HE, SHE, THEY	KEEP THE ACTIVE - IT IS A STORY

WHERE EACH PIECE OF ADVICE IS TRUE

use the active

in a story about people doing things

the passive is weak

when the agent matters and is hidden

the passive is right

in a method, a rule or a specification

the test

what is this paragraph about? Keep it in subject position

Underline the subject of every sentence in a paragraph you have written. If it changes more than once, the paragraph is about more than one thing.

Two true pieces of advice that contradict each other

Four subjects in four sentences, and one topic throughout

The last row is the one where the advice you were given holds

One underline per sentence is the whole diagnosis

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Four paragraphs that change subject every sentence — A learner taught to avoid the passive writes a paragraph about four different things.

STUDY FILE • The passive you were taught to avoid

9A • It was done by me 🎧 Track 2.4

Learners are taught that the passive is weak writing and then meet it on every page of everything they read professionally. The result is a learner who can form it and will not use it, and whose paragraphs change subject in every sentence.

what you were told	use the active; the passive is weak
where it is true	in a story about people doing things
where it is false	in a report, a method, a specification or a procedure
the test	what is this paragraph about? Keep that in subject position

9B • Keep the topic

Take a paragraph you have written in English. **Underline the subject of every sentence.** If it changes more than once, rewrite so that it does not.

9C • Role play — by whom?

In pairs. One of you describes a process. The other asks *by whom?* after every sentence. **Four rounds each,** and count how often the answer is *it does not matter*.

9D • The sentence you cannot write actively

Everybody has one: a method, a rule, a thing done to you. **Find yours and write it both ways.** The active version is usually longer and names somebody irrelevant.

9E • Transfer — before next week

Find one real document in your field and count its passives. Bring the count, and mark three as unknown, obvious or protected.

Part 10 • Mediation & Interaction ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE



Thirty-eight minutes, seven lines, twenty-six passives — What happened, what was written down, and where the agent went.

10A • Relay

Half the class has the report. Half has the chain-of-custody sheet and the camera times.

Reconstruct the thirty-eight minutes by speaking only. Ten minutes.

10B • Simplify — for one reader

The customer writes: *Who let my container leave uncleared?* **Reply in four sentences**, two active and two passive, and say in each case why.

10C • Online

Write **one message** asking for the camera feed. **Three sentences.** Do not accuse anybody of not having requested it.

10D • Your language

Does your language have a passive, and if not, what does it use instead? **Translate all six sentences from Part 2.** Which ones force you to supply an agent?

Part 11 • The Decision ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

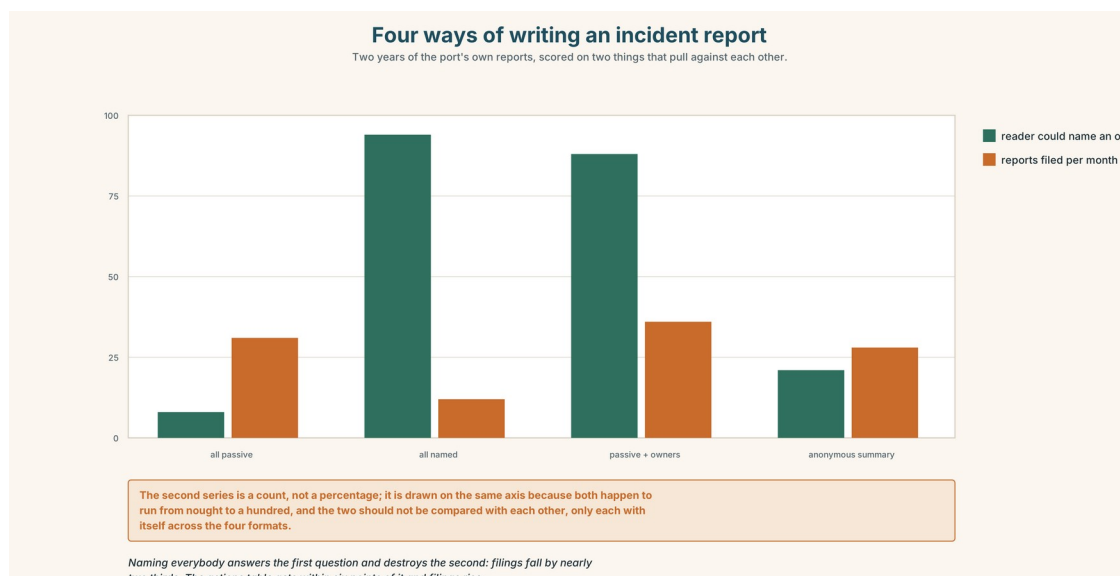
How the port writes incident reports

Option one: keep the convention. Agentless reporting is what makes people report at all; name individuals and the next near miss will not be filed.

Option two: name everybody involved, every time. A report that cannot say who did what is not a report.

Option three: keep the narrative in the passive, and require an actions table in which every line has an owner, a date and a verb.

11A • The evidence



{width=6.

6in}

Four ways of writing an incident report — Two years of the port's own reports, scored on two things that pull against each other.

Track 2.6. Aïcha Benali, shift supervisor, 30 seconds: "Nineteen years and I have filed about two hundred of these. I have never once been afraid of being named. What I am afraid of is being named for something the system made inevitable, which is a different thing, and the report form has no box for it. Give me a box for it and I will put my name in the one above."

11B • Talk about it

In threes. Use the frame, and choose the voice of every sentence on purpose.

I would _____, because _____. The agent here is _____, and that is _____.

11C • Decide

Write **three sentences**: the decision, the evidence, and the one passive you would refuse to allow.

11D • Model decision

Option three. Naming everybody is the right instinct and the wrong mechanism: it names the hand and not the system, and the hand is almost never where the finding is. The narrative stays in the passive because a narrative about a consignment should be about the consignment. The table is what makes the report answerable, and it costs eight lines. If a line in it has no owner, the finding is a system finding, and that is information rather than a gap.

11E • The Reveal

What happened. The port kept the passive narrative and added the actions table. Reports filed per month rose from thirty-one to thirty-six.

Then something nobody predicted: the proportion of reports whose findings named a system rather than a person rose from a fifth to more than half. The table had not made people easier to blame; it had made it obvious, line by line, when there was nobody to write down — and that blank had become a finding instead of a silence.

One question. You do not have to answer it out loud.

Nothing in the narrative changed. Why did the findings?

Part 12 • Landing ♦ all three lines

12A • Recycle — fifteen items

1. The gate _____ at 02.02. *(two words, passive)*
2. _____ to release the consignment. *(three words)*
3. _____ at a meeting nobody minuted. *(four words)*
4. _____ since the incident. *(four words)*
5. _____ by the compliance team. *(four words)*
6. _____ that the gate was already open. *(three words)*
7. The container left _____ between 02.02 and 02.40. *(three words)*
8. The release was _____ a supervisor. *(three words)*
9. The board asked twice: _____ ? *(three words)*
10. The finding is _____. *(three words)*
11. _____. *(four words — the sentence that closes the file)*
12. _____. *(five words — the refusal to be drawn)*
13. Somebody has to _____ the line-five gap. *(two words)*
14. The shift will _____ at 02.00 as usual. *(two words)*
15. The outgoing crew should have _____ the open gate. *(two words)*

12B • Consolidate — one task, everything in it

Write 150 words describing something that went wrong, with the voice of every sentence chosen and three of them annotated in the margin: unknown, obvious, protected.

12C • Can-do, with evidence

☐ I can choose the voice of a sentence for information structure. **Evidence:** 3H, 8D ☐ I can tell an unknown agent from a protected one. **Evidence:** 5E, 4D ☐ I can write a finding that has an owner. **Evidence:** 6E, 10B ☐ I can de-stress an agent that arrives at the end. **Evidence:** 7C

12D • Replay

Record 0C again. **Compare.** Which of your two versions was easier, and what does that tell you?

12E • Glossary — fifty items, as a map

WHAT MOVED, AND WHAT WAS WRITTEN DOWN · consignment · record · procedure · clearance **WHO WAS SUPPOSED TO SEE IT** · supervisor · authorisation · oversight **WHAT HAPPENS WHEN IT GOES WRONG** · breach · negligence · liability · custody · escalation **THE REPORT'S FURNITURE** · chain of custody · standard operating procedure · the shift handover · a near miss · root cause **THE SENTENCES IT USES** · at some point · the goods were released · a procedural failure · on whose authority · signed off by **WHAT THE SHIFT DOES** · sign off · hand over · flag up · look into · follow up · put down to **IN THE ROOM** · it was authorised · nobody has been named · that is above my pay grade **THE ADVERBS** · inadvertently · routinely · systematically · unaccountably · belatedly · independently · formally · provisionally **THE FRAMES** · it was decided · mistakes have been identified · action has been taken · a decision was taken · it is understood · steps are being taken · the matter is being reviewed · no individual has been identified **CLOSING THE FILE** · lessons have been learned · an error occurred · we are unable to comment

12F • Next

Unit 3 • How much can one noun carry?